`WebApplicationBuilder` configures a lot of things by default, including

- *Configuration*—Your app loads values from JSON files and environment variables that you can use to control the app's runtime behavior, such as loading connection strings for a database. You'll learn more about the configuration system in chapter 10.
- *Logging*—ASP.NET Core includes an extensible logging system for observability and debugging. I cover the logging system in detail in chapter 26.
- *Services*—Any classes that your application depends on for providing functionality—both those used by the framework and those specific to your application—must be registered so that they can be instantiated correctly at runtime. The `WebApplicationBuilder` configures the minimal set of services needed for an ASP.NET Core app. Chapters 8 and 9 look at service configuration in detail.
- *Hosting*—ASP.NET Core uses the Kestrel web server by default to handle requests.

After configuring the `WebApplicationBuilder` you call `Build()` to create a `WebApplication` instance. The `WebApplication` instance is where you define how your application handles and responds to requests, using two building blocks:

- *Middleware*—These small components execute in sequence when the application receives an HTTP request. They can perform a whole host of functions, such as logging, identifying the current user for a request, serving static files, and handling errors. We'll look in detail at the middleware pipeline in chapter 4.
- *Endpoints*—Endpoints define how the response should be generated for a specific request to a URL in your app.